

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 3

Group 3 Vocabulary

1. Abate

Meaning: To decrease, reduce, or become less intense.

Tip to remember: Think of “a bait” being removed from anger or storm; the intensity goes down.

Sentence: The storm finally abated after several hours.

2. Abjure

Meaning: To formally reject or give up a belief, claim, or habit.

Tip to remember: “Ab” means away, and “jure” relates to oath. Abjure means to swear away from something.

Sentence: He decided to abjure violence and follow a peaceful path.

3. Anomalous

Meaning: Unusual; different from what is normal or expected.

Tip to remember: Anomalous comes from anomaly, which means something abnormal.

Sentence: The scientist noticed an anomalous result in the experiment.

4. Antipathy

Meaning: A strong dislike or hatred.

Tip to remember: “Anti” means against, and “pathy” relates to feeling. Antipathy means a feeling against something.

Sentence: She felt antipathy toward people who treated workers unfairly.

5. Arcane

Meaning: Mysterious, secret, or understood by only a few people.

Tip to remember: Think of an ancient secret hidden in an old cave. That knowledge is arcane.

Sentence: The professor explained an arcane theory of physics.

6. Arduous

Meaning: Very difficult and requiring much effort.

Tip to remember: Arduous sounds like “hard to do.” It means something is very hard to do.

Sentence: Preparing for the GRE is an arduous but rewarding process.

7. **Artless**
Meaning: Natural, simple, and without trickery; innocent.
Tip to remember: “Art” can mean clever trick. Artless means without tricks, so simple and sincere.
Sentence: The child’s artless smile made everyone happy.
8. **Ascetic**
Meaning: A person who avoids comfort and luxury for religious or spiritual reasons.
Tip to remember: Think of a monk living with almost nothing. That monk is ascetic.
Sentence: The ascetic lived in a small hut with very few possessions.
9. **Assuage**
Meaning: To calm, reduce, or make something less severe.
Tip to remember: Assuage sounds like “massage.” A massage can calm pain; assuage means to calm or reduce.
Sentence: The teacher tried to assuage the students’ fear before the exam.
10. **Betray**
Meaning: To be disloyal; to reveal something unintentionally.
Tip to remember: Betray can mean two things: betray a friend, or betray your feelings by showing them.
Sentence: His shaking voice betrayed his nervousness.
11. **Bucolic**
Meaning: Related to the countryside; rural and peaceful.
Tip to remember: Think of cows, green fields, and village life. That peaceful rural scene is bucolic.
Sentence: They enjoyed the bucolic beauty of the village.
12. **Burgeon**
Meaning: To grow or develop quickly.
Tip to remember: Think of a bud suddenly growing into a flower. Burgeon means rapid growth.
Sentence: The city began to burgeon after new industries arrived.
13. **Cacophonous**
Meaning: Having a harsh, unpleasant, and noisy sound.
Tip to remember: “Caco” means bad, and “phon” means sound. Cacophonous means bad sound.
Sentence: The cacophonous traffic made it difficult to study.
14. **Canonize**
Meaning: To officially declare someone a saint; to treat someone as highly respected.
Tip to remember: Think of a religious canon making someone a saint. Canonize means to honor officially.
Sentence: Many people canonize great leaders after their death.

15. **Censure**
Meaning: Strong criticism or official disapproval.
Tip to remember: Censure sounds like “censor.” Both involve disapproval of something.
Sentence: The committee censured the official for corruption.
16. **Chicanery**
Meaning: Trickery or deception, especially in politics or law.
Tip to remember: Think of a cheating politician using clever tricks. That is chicanery.
Sentence: The public was tired of political chicanery.
17. **Coalesce**
Meaning: To come together and form one whole.
Tip to remember: Think of small water drops joining together into one big drop. They coalesce.
Sentence: Several small groups coalesced into one strong movement.
18. **Cogent**
Meaning: Clear, logical, and convincing.
Tip to remember: Cogent sounds like “coherent agent.” A cogent argument is clear and powerful.
Sentence: She gave a cogent explanation for her decision.
19. **Compelling**
Meaning: Very convincing, powerful, or interesting.
Tip to remember: Compelling means something pulls your attention strongly.
Sentence: The lawyer presented compelling evidence in court.
20. **Contend**
Meaning: To argue, claim, or compete.
Tip to remember: Think of two people in a contest. They contend with each other.
Sentence: The researcher contends that solar power will become cheaper.
21. **Copious**
Meaning: Large in amount; abundant.
Tip to remember: Think of “copies” of notes in huge numbers. Copious means a lot.
Sentence: She took copious notes during the lecture.
22. **Cosmopolitan**
Meaning: Familiar with many cultures; international and worldly.
Tip to remember: “Cosmo” means world. A cosmopolitan person belongs to the world, not just one place.
Sentence: Kathmandu is becoming more cosmopolitan with tourists from many countries.

23. **Deference**
Meaning: Respectful submission to someone else's opinion or authority.
Tip to remember: Think of "deferring" to a senior person because you respect them.
Sentence: The students listened in deference to their professor.
24. **Desultory**
Meaning: Lacking a clear plan, purpose, or order; random.
Tip to remember: Think of studying randomly without a schedule. That is desultory study.
Sentence: His desultory preparation led to poor exam results.
25. **Diffident**
Meaning: Shy and lacking self-confidence.
Tip to remember: Diffident sounds like "different confidence." Actually, it means low confidence.
Sentence: The diffident student hesitated to ask questions.
26. **Dilatory**
Meaning: Slow and causing delay.
Tip to remember: Dilatory sounds like "delay-tory." It means delaying.
Sentence: His dilatory behavior made the team miss the deadline.
27. **Equivocate**
Meaning: To speak unclearly in order to avoid giving a direct answer.
Tip to remember: Think of giving "equal voices" to both yes and no, so no one knows your real answer.
Sentence: The politician equivocated when asked about the scandal.
28. **Polarize**
Meaning: To divide people into two strongly opposing groups.
Tip to remember: Think of the North Pole and South Pole, two opposite sides. Polarize means to split into extremes.
Sentence: The controversial decision polarized the community.
29. **Prodigal**
Meaning: Wastefully extravagant; spending too much.
Tip to remember: Think of a person who produces big bills by spending carelessly.
Sentence: His prodigal lifestyle left him in debt.
30. **Verbose**
Meaning: Using too many words.
Tip to remember: "Verb" relates to words. Verbose means full of unnecessary words.
Sentence: The verbose essay could have been much shorter.